AAAJ-Style Systematic Literature Review Writing Template

Derived from a published journal article PDF after deep reading gate approval

Use this document as a writing scaffold. Replace every bracketed placeholder with the new paper topic, theory, corpus, methods, and findings. Do not copy the source article content.

Reading Gate Summary

[Gate result]* *Deep reading gate passed before this Word template was created.

[Use rule]* *Do not generate or fill this template until article identity, core argument, section logic, paragraph roles, evidence devices, language moves, and transferable structure are understood.

Front Matter

Title

[Title formula]* *Unpacking [concept/field]: a systematic literature review and research agenda

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Structured Abstract

Abstract Move	Paragraph Function
Purpose	State review aim, literature field, and what the review investigates.
Design/methodology/approach	State review type, corpus size, databases/sources, date range, and outlet/source boundary.
Findings	Present staged outputs: classification, mapping/visualisation, and narrative synthesis.
Originality/value	Explain the distinctive contribution and future research agenda.
Keywords	List 5-7 field, theory, method, and domain terms.
Paper type	Research paper

1. Introduction

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Field emergence	Introduce the topic as an emerging/productive field and explain why it matters.	[Field emergence: write new topic-specific content here.]
Core conceptual contrast	Define the central contrast that gives the article its conceptual stakes.	[Core conceptual contrast: write new topic-specific content here.]
Prior literature examples	Show that existing scholarship has proposed tools, variants, or approaches.	[Prior literature examples: write new topic-specific content here.]
Review warrant and research questions	Convert field growth and dispersion into a review problem.	[Review warrant and research questions: write new topic-specific content here.]
Review purpose	State two or three purposes: understand, cluster/map, and set agenda.	[Review purpose: write new topic-specific content here.]
Roadmap	Preview each section in sequence.	[Roadmap: write new topic-specific content here.]

2. Antecedents / Theoretical Background

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Intellectual ancestors	Name the theories/traditions that shaped the field.	[Intellectual ancestors: write new topic-specific content here.]
Theory cluster 1	Explain core idea and relevance to the review topic.	[Theory cluster 1: write new topic-specific content here.]
Theory cluster 2	Explain second intellectual source and its role.	[Theory cluster 2: write new topic-specific content here.]
Theory cluster 3	Explain third source or debate if relevant.	[Theory cluster 3: write new topic-specific content here.]
Transition	Show how the background motivates the review design.	[Transition: write new topic-specific content here.]

3. Review Design and Exploratory Analyses

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Opening method rationale	Explain why SLR defines the field boundary and why additional methods are needed.	[Opening method rationale: write new topic-specific content here.]
3.1 Systematic literature review	State databases, search string, inclusion criteria, screening, final corpus, and period.	[3.1 Systematic literature review: write new topic-specific content here.]
3.2 Content analysis	Define coding categories and explain how articles become comparable units.	[3.2 Content analysis: write new topic-specific content here.]
3.3 Bibliometric visualisations	Explain mapping methods and what each visualisation contributes.	[3.3 Bibliometric visualisations: write new topic-specific content here.]

4. Narrative Review and Discussion of Contributions

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Opening rationale	Explain why narrative review focuses on influential/high-quality/innovative works.	[Opening rationale: write new topic-specific content here.]
Phase 1	Discuss seminal/theoretical foundations of the field.	[Phase 1: write new topic-specific content here.]
Phase 2	Discuss maturity, consolidation, and core debates.	[Phase 2: write new topic-specific content here.]
Phase 3	Discuss emerging topics and new empirical domains.	[Phase 3: write new topic-specific content here.]
Phase 4	Discuss innovative methodologies and future-facing applications.	[Phase 4: write new topic-specific content here.]
Transition	Link narrative findings to research agenda.	[Transition: write new topic-specific content here.]

5. Discussion and Conclusions

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Overall synthesis	State what the review reveals about the field trajectory.	[Overall synthesis: write new topic-specific content here.]
Future agenda direction 1	Name an agenda area and explain why it follows from the review.	[Future agenda direction 1: write new topic-specific content here.]
Future agenda direction 2	Explain contextual/institutional implications.	[Future agenda direction 2: write new topic-specific content here.]
Future agenda direction 3	Explain methodological or technological implications.	[Future agenda direction 3: write new topic-specific content here.]
Closing conceptual warning	Protect the concept from dilution or purely legitimating use.	[Closing conceptual warning: write new topic-specific content here.]

References

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Reference function	Support theory, reviewed corpus, and method choices consistently with journal style.	[Reference function: write new topic-specific content here.]

Appendix

Paragraph/Cluster	Function	Fillable Draft Space
Supplementary function	Hold corpus lists, search details, or extra classifications for transparency.	[Supplementary function: write new topic-specific content here.]

Language Moves

[Gap building] ***Present the field as productive but dispersed, then explain why a review is needed.***

[Theory positioning] ***Introduce intellectual traditions before the method so the review has conceptual depth.***

[Method justification] ***Explain why systematic review is necessary but not sufficient for a complex field.***

[Synthesis language] ***Move from collected contributions to phases, themes, and agenda.***

[Contribution language] ***Frame contribution as both retrospective mapping and prospective agenda.***

[Limitation/future language] ***Ground future work in observed gaps and contextual risks.***

Quality Checklist

- Every section has a clear argument function.
- Every paragraph cluster tells the writer what to do, not what to copy.
- Tables and figures have evidence functions, not decorative functions.
- The template distinguishes transferable structure from source-specific content.
- The finished paper should answer both: what has been done and what could be done.